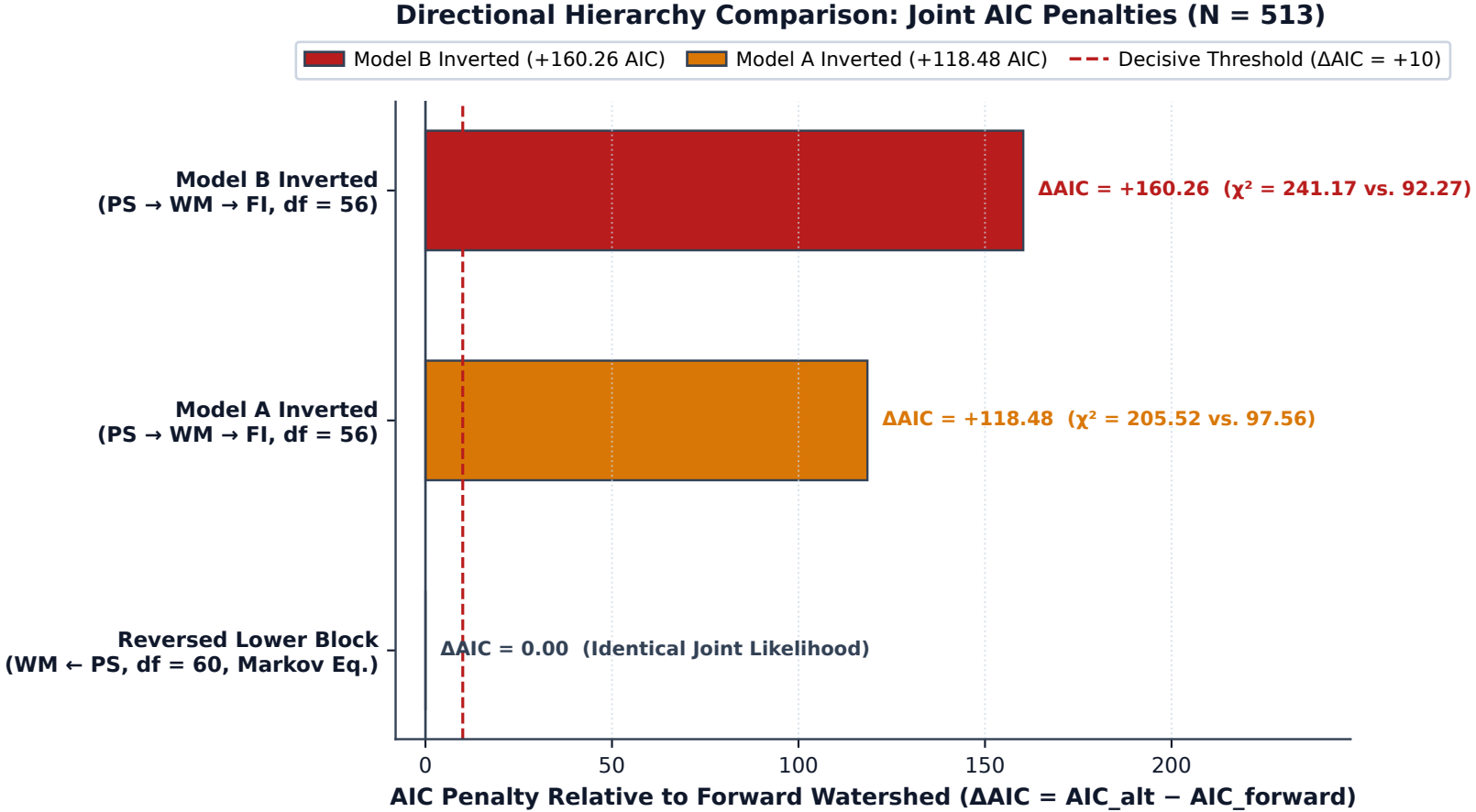
Directional Hierarchy Comparison: Joint AIC Penalties (N = 513)
Model B Inverted (+160.26 AIC)
Model A Inverted (+118.48 AIC)
Decisive Threshold (ΔAIC = +10)
Model B Inverted
(PS → WM → FI, df = 56)
ΔAIC = +160.26 (χ² = 241.17 vs. 92.27)
Model A Inverted
(PS → WM → FI, df = 56)
ΔAIC = +118.48 (χ² = 205.52 vs. 97.56)
Reversed Lower Block
(WM ← PS, df = 60, Markov Eq.)
ΔAIC = 0.00 (Identical Joint Likelihood)
0
50
100
150
200
AIC Penalty Relative to Forward Watershed (ΔAIC = AIC_alt − AIC_forward)